

media files, we'd probably call it a gallery application; if it only managed users it would be a contact management application; If it only managed links you'd call it a bookmarking application. The fact that it manages all of these, and provides a way to customise how they are presented, and how they relate to each other is why people call it a CMS.

For instance, you can create multiple categories, and articles to these categories that have media files embedded in them, they have proper tags, and allow adding comments. Articles have an author, and you can see all articles by a particular author if you so wish. Users can have different roles. For instance while an

administrator might be able to modify all aspects of the website, an author would only be able to add articles, and edit articles they themselves have created. An editor would be able to edit any article or create a new one, and a regular user can simply view the content.

If you've always thought of WordPress as being a blogging platform, and are now confused by our instance that it is in fact a CMS, here is what you need to know. A blog is essentially a CMS that is specialised for regularly posting content, which is supposed to be displayed, accessed and consumed chronologically. CMSs that specialise in this use case are often called blogging platforms / frameworks / engines. While WordPress started with this specialisation it has since grown to encompass features that are useful for more general use cases beyond simply build a blog.

A website for a product, let's say a television set, just needs a collection of content that is categorised to provide different forms of information about the product. You might have the home page display enticing photos of the television set while a gallery page displays even more images. Another page could have video clips of the advertisements for that television set. A specifications page could have basic information about the product, while a support page could have a list of common issues, troubleshooting and warranty information. While this content might need to be updated from time to time, it will be laid out very differently than a blog, which would just have a series of entries over time.

Of course to manage such a site you will need the ability to create, store and organise text content, media content, and forms; all things that



WORDPRESS

WordPress is one of the most popular CMS software and for good reason.

It is easy to install, set up, use and administer.